

# Rounding Boundaries and Place-Holding Zeros

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**How to work:**

- To round, find the place you are rounding to, then look at the **one digit to its right**. That digit decides: 5 or more rounds up, less than 5 stays.
- A rounded number keeps every place it started with. Rounding 5,048 to the nearest hundred gives 5,000 — the zeros hold the tens and ones places open.
- Always round the **original** number. Never round twice in a row.
- Show your thinking in the space, then write your answer on the line.

1. Round 3,472 to the nearest hundred.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

2. Round 2,961 to the nearest hundred. Watch what happens to the thousands place.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**3. Find the mistake.** Jo rounds 4,750 to the nearest hundred and writes 4,700. She says, “the next digit is a 5, and 5 is not more than 5, so the 7 stays.”

- (a) Which digit decides this rounding, and what is the rule when that digit is exactly 5?  
Answer in one sentence.
- (b) Round 4,750 to the nearest hundred correctly.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**4. Find the mistake.** Ravi rounds 5,048 to the nearest hundred. He decides the hundreds digit stays, and writes 50.

- (a) Explain in one sentence why the rounded number must keep its zeros.
- (b) Round 5,048 to the nearest hundred correctly.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

5. Write  $<$  or  $>$  in the box to compare these two numbers. They use the same digits, but not in the same places.

$$4,806 \quad \boxed{\phantom{00}} \quad 4,860$$

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

6. A school library has 3,472 books and orders 2,961 more. Estimate the new total by rounding *each* number to the nearest hundred first, then adding.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

7. Write the number that is 10 more than 4,995. Then write which places had to change and why.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**8. Challenge.** Round 2,548 three different ways.

(a) To the nearest ten: \_\_\_\_\_

(b) To the nearest hundred: \_\_\_\_\_

(c) To the nearest thousand: \_\_\_\_\_

Kim did part (b) by rounding her answer from part (a) instead of the original number, and got 2,600. Explain in one sentence why that gives the wrong answer.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_